

COVERS LOGIC PRO 10.7 → 11 → 12

LOGIC PRO CRASH COURSE

350+ GOLDEN NUGGET TRICKS

NO LONG TUTORIALS. NO FLUFF. JUST WHAT ACTUALLY WORKS.

361

TRICKS

19

SECTIONS

100%

CLICKABLE

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EVERY ENTRY IS A LINK. CLICK IT AND YOU ARE THERE.

START HERE

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Do not read this front to back. Jump to the section that matches what you are stuck on right now, take the trick, and get back to the music. Every section is one click away from every page.

Each entry is short on purpose. Title, what it does, the key command. Ten seconds to read, yours for good.

- Every key command shown is the Logic Pro factory default on a US keyboard. If you have remapped anything, open Key Commands with `⌘K` and search the command name — the name is always given.
- Where a trick lives in a menu rather than on a key, the full menu path is written out, so it stays correct across versions.
- Tricks marked GOLDEN NUGGET are the ones worth stealing first.
- Tricks marked ADD YOUR NOTES are template slots for you to fill in.
- Nothing here requires third-party plugins. It is all stock Logic.

THE ONE HABIT THAT MATTERS MOST

Every time you catch yourself doing something with the mouse for the third time, check whether it has a key command. If it does, learn it. If it does not, make one. That single habit is worth more than any individual trick in this book.

REFERENCE

KEY LEGEND

Logic's documentation and this book both use the Mac modifier symbols. If you are coming from another DAW, this is the page to bookmark.



COMMAND

The workhorse. Most structural commands.



OPTION

Almost always means copy, all, or alternate behaviour.



SHIFT

Extends a selection or reverses a command.



CONTROL

Fine adjustments, and secondary click.



RETURN

Sends the playhead to the start of the project.



DELETE

Removes the selection.

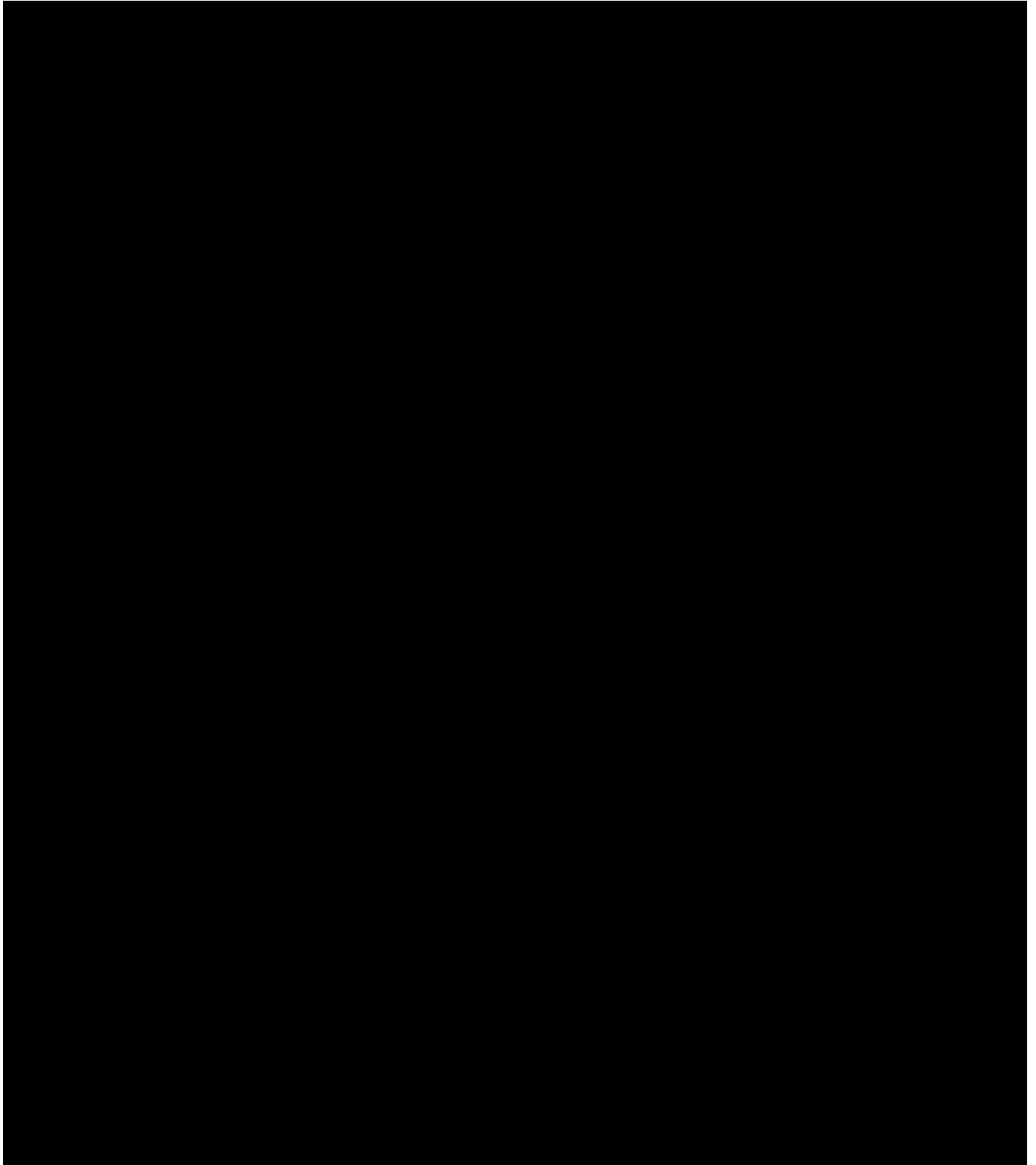


SPACE

Play / Stop. The most used key in the program.

THREE MODIFIER RULES THAT EXPLAIN MOST OF LOGIC

Hold $\sim$ while dragging anything and you copy it instead of moving it. Hold $\sim$ while clicking any control and you reset it to its default. Hold $\sim$ while clicking a button in a channel strip and the change applies to every channel at once. Learn these three and you can guess your way through most of the program.



LEARN THESE FIRST

THE BASIC KEY COMMANDS

If you learn nothing else, learn this page. These are the commands you will use hundreds of times a day, and they are the foundation every other section builds on.

TRANSPORT

SPACE	Play / Stop
↶	Go to beginning of project
R	Record
C	Cycle on / off
K	Metronome on / off
⌘.	Stop and discard the recording just made
U	Set locators by selected regions
/	Open the Go to Position dialog

WINDOWS AND VIEWS

X	Show / hide Mixer
P	Show / hide Piano Roll
E	Show / hide Editor
N	Show / hide Score Editor
Y	Show / hide Library
O	Show / hide Loop Browser
F	Show / hide Browsers
B	Show / hide Smart Controls
I	Show / hide Inspector
G	Show / hide Global Tracks
V	Hide / show all plug-in windows

EDITING

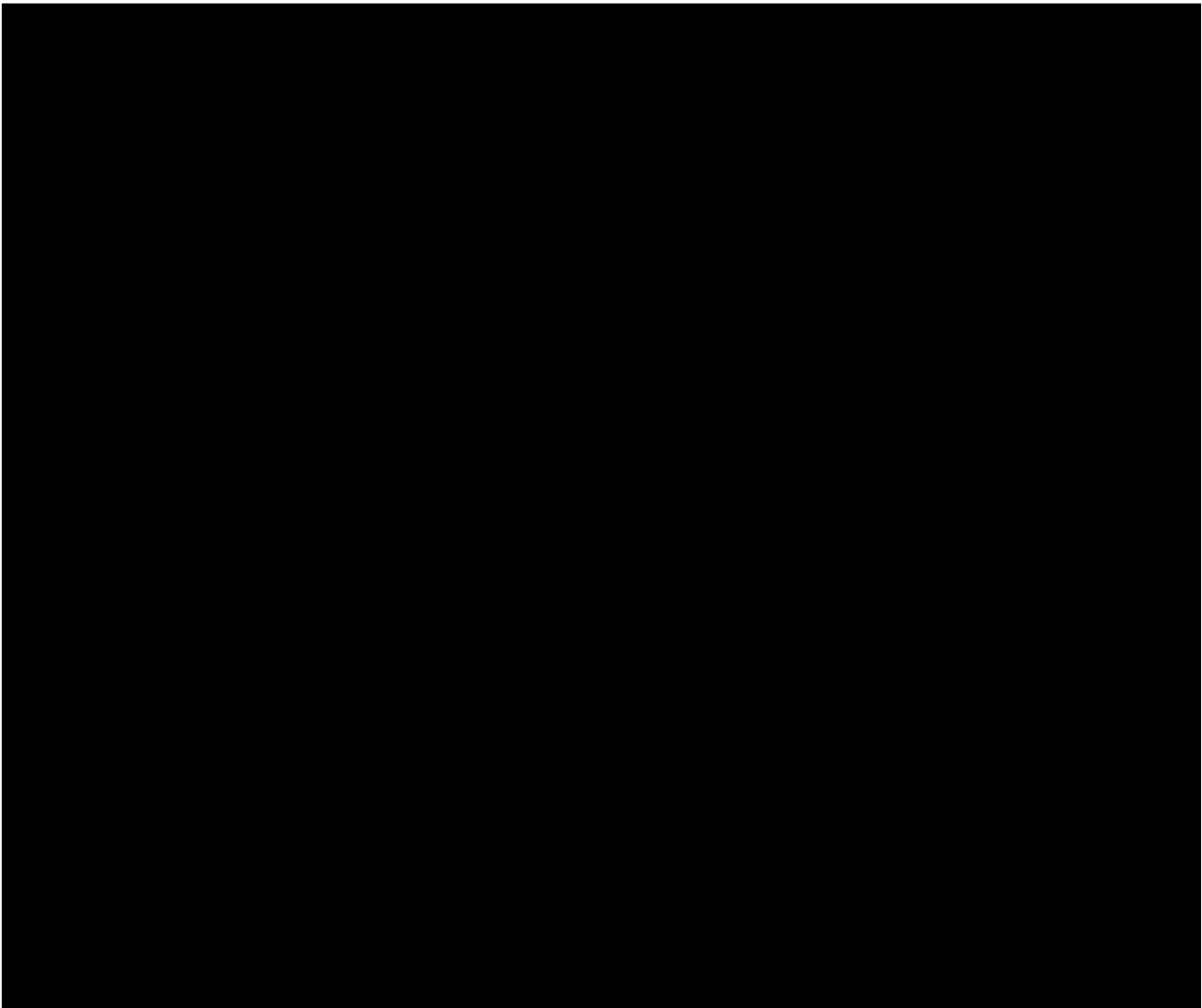
⌘ Z	Undo
⇧ ⌘ Z	Redo
⌘ T	Split regions at playhead
⌘ J	Join selected regions
⌘ R	Repeat regions or events
⌘ D	New track with duplicate settings
⌘ A	Select all
⇧ ⌘ A	Deselect all
⌘ + DRAG	Copy instead of move
⌘ + DRAG	Marquee select (default secondary tool)

ZOOM AND NAVIGATION

Z	Zoom to fit selection, press again to return
⌘ ← / ⌘ →	Zoom out / in horizontally
⌘ ↑ / ⌘ ↓	Zoom out / in vertically
^ ⌘ + DRAG	Drag-zoom to any area

CAPTURE AND OUTPUT

⌘ R	Flashback Capture — grab what you just played
⌘ S	Save
⇧ ⌘ S	Save as
⌘ B	Bounce project or section
^ B	Bounce regions in place
⌘ K	Open Key Commands
⌘ ,	Open Settings



SECTION 01

SETTING UP MY PREFERRED SETTINGS.

41 TRICKS

Before a single note goes down, get the program out of your way. This is the longest section in the book on purpose — an hour spent here saves you a hundred hours later. Everything below is a setting I change on every fresh install.

AUDIO PREFERENCES

LOGIC PRO > SETTINGS > AUDIO

001

GOLDEN NUGGET

Run two buffer sizes, not one

Set I/O Buffer to 64 or 128 while tracking so you can play in time, then switch to 512 or 1024 when you mix so plugins stop crackling. Nothing else in Logic changes your day this much.

⌘,

002

Turn on Low Latency Mode and give it a key command

Low Latency Mode temporarily bypasses plugins that introduce delay so you can overdub into a heavy mix without changing the buffer. Assign it a key and hit it the moment you arm a track.

⌘K TO ASSIGN

003

Set Processing Threads to Automatic

Manually pinning thread counts was useful a decade ago. On Apple silicon, Automatic consistently beats hand tuning. Leave it alone.

004

Enable Multithreading on Playback Tracks

Under Audio > Devices, set Multithreading to “Playback Tracks”. It spreads live tracks across cores instead of choking one.

005

Raise Process Buffer Range to Large for mixing

This is separate from the I/O buffer and it buys you real headroom on plugin-heavy projects. Drop it back to Small only if you notice sluggish response.

006

Uncheck Software Monitoring if you monitor through your interface

If your interface has zero-latency direct monitoring, Logic’s software monitoring just adds a second, slightly late copy of your voice. Turn it off and the doubling disappears.

007

Set the count-in to 1 bar, not 2

Two bars feels safe and wastes hours over a project. One bar with the click already running is enough for any competent player.

008

Turn off “Allow Quick Punch-In” only if you never punch

Leave it on. It lets you drop into record mid-playback with R and keeps the audio before the punch point intact, which is a lifesaver when a take suddenly gets good.

009

GOLDEN NUGGET

Set MIDI recording to “Create Take Folder”

Under Recording > MIDI, choosing take folders for cycle recording means every pass is preserved and swappable instead of merged into mush.

010

Enable “Auto demix by channel if multitrack recording”

If you record a keyboard rig that sends on multiple MIDI channels, this splits the performance onto separate tracks automatically.

011

Turn on the pre-roll metronome click only

In the Metronome settings, enable “Click while recording” and disable “Click while playing”. You get the click when you need it and silence when you are listening back.

K

012

Set the click source to a sound you can actually hear

Open the Metronome settings and swap the default woodblock for a rimshot or cowbell, then set the accented downbeat louder. A click you have to strain for is a click you will drift against.

013

Turn on “Scrub Instrument Regions in Arrange”

Off by default. On, you can drag the playhead over MIDI and hear the notes, which makes finding a spot by ear instantly possible.

014

Set the MIDI reset options to send Notes Off only

Under MIDI > Reset Messages, uncheck everything except All Notes Off. The other resets can wipe controller states on hardware synths mid-session.

015

Enable “Display middle C as C3”

Under Display > General, choose whether middle C reads as C3 or C4 and match it to whatever your hardware and sample libraries use. Mismatched octave numbering causes more transposition mistakes than anything else.

016

Raise the maximum MIDI recording time

In MIDI > General, the default cap on cycle recording length will cut you off during long improvised passes. Raise it once and forget it.

017

Turn off “Soft Through” for controllers with local control on

If your synth plays a doubled, slightly flammed note when you press a key, this is why. Turn off local control on the synth or Soft Through in Logic — one of the two, never neither.

018

GOLDEN NUGGET

Turn on “Show Advanced Tools” first, always

Under Settings > Advanced, tick Show Advanced Tools and then tick every sub-option. Without this, huge parts of Logic — including surround, MIDI environment and advanced editing — are simply hidden from you.

019

Set region names to display at a size you can read

Display > Tracks lets you scale region name text independently of zoom. Bump it up; squinting is not a workflow.

020

Enable waveform display “Rectified” for level work

Rectified waveforms fold the negative half up, which makes level differences between takes far easier to eyeball.

021

Turn off region colouring by track and colour by region instead

Under Display > Tracks > Region Colour, choosing “As Region Colour” lets you colour-code by part rather than by track, which scales much better on big arrangements.

022

Turn on “Show Help Tags”

Help tags show exact position, length and delta values while you drag. They are how you edit precisely without opening a single numeric field.

023

Set Cycle to “Auto-set locators by region selection”

Under General > Cycle, this makes selecting a region and hitting C loop exactly that region. It turns cycle into a one-key operation.

024

Turn on “Select regions on track selection”

Small setting, enormous effect. Clicking a track header selects that track's regions, so every region command becomes a two-step operation instead of a hunt.

025

GOLDEN NUGGET

Set “Limit Dragging to One Direction” to Vertically in the Tracks area

This stops you from nudging a perfectly placed region off the grid while trying to move it to another track. It is the single most common accidental edit in Logic.

026

Turn off “Catch playhead” while editing

The Catch button in each editor stops the view from chasing the playhead. Turn it off when you are editing a specific bar and on when you are listening through. The command is “Catch Playhead Position” — check its key in $\text{⌘}K$.

027

Set the maximum undo steps to 100+

Under General > Editing, raise the undo count. RAM is cheap; a lost hour is not.

028

Turn on “Ask before deleting unused audio files”

The Project > Clean Up command can permanently delete audio. Make it ask you first, every single time.

029

Set your sample rate before you record, not after

Under Project Settings > Audio, pick 48 kHz for anything that might touch video and 44.1 kHz for pure music. Changing it later resamples everything and softens transients.

030

Set the project bit depth to 24-bit

32-bit float is available and useful if your interface supports it, but 24-bit is the safe universal default. Never record at 16-bit.

031

GOLDEN NUGGET

Turn on Smart Tempo “Keep Project Tempo” by default

Under Project Settings > Smart Tempo, set the project mode to Keep. Adaptive mode is powerful but it will rewrite your tempo map from a single dragged-in loop if you are not paying attention.

032

Set the default region quantise to Off

Under Project Settings > Recording, make sure incoming MIDI is not auto-quantised. Capture the performance first; quantise as a decision, not as an accident.

033

Set Tuning to Equal Temperament unless you mean otherwise

Project Settings > Tuning quietly affects every software instrument. If a synth sounds subtly wrong against a sample, check here first.

034

Turn on “Bounce project settings” for consistent exports

Under Project Settings > Assets, tick the options to copy audio files, samples and impulse responses into the project. Your project becomes portable in one move.

035

GOLDEN NUGGET

Save a Session Start template and set it as the default

Build one project with your usual tracks, buses, reverb and marker colours, then File > Save as Template. Set it to open on launch and you never build a session from zero again.

036

Set a default channel strip for new audio tracks

Right-click any channel strip setting in the Library and choose "Save as Performance Default". Every new track of that type starts with your gain staging and metering already in place.

037

Set the default region colour palette

Open the colour palette with `⌘C` and rearrange it once. Consistent colours across every project makes navigating an old session instant.

`⌘C`

038

Turn on Project Alternatives before you need them

File > Alternatives > New Alternative gives you branching versions inside one project file. Make one before every big arrangement change.

039

Set autosave and then still hit `⌘S`

Logic autosaves, but only Logic knows when. Build the reflex of hitting `⌘S` every time you finish a thought.

`⌘S`

040

Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose

Logic Pro > Sound Library > Relocate Sound Library lets you move tens of gigabytes off your system drive without breaking a single patch.

041

Set the audio file location to "Project" not "Folder"

Keeping recorded audio inside the project package means dragging one file to a hard drive moves everything. Only switch to a folder if you are working with an enormous session across multiple drives.

SECTION 02

ARRANGEMENT TRICKS.

18 TRICKS

Arranging is mostly moving big blocks of time around without breaking anything. These tricks let you restructure a whole song in seconds instead of dragging regions one by one and praying.

MOVING TIME, NOT REGIONS

042

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections

Open Global Tracks with G, enable the Arrangement track, and drop markers on your Verse, Chorus and Bridge. Now drag the Chorus marker and the entire section — every track, every automation point — moves with it.

G

043

Drag an arrangement marker onto another to swap sections

Dropping a Chorus marker on top of a Verse marker swaps their positions rather than overwriting. Trying three different song orders takes about fifteen seconds.

044

⌘-drag an arrangement marker to duplicate a section

Hold ⌘ and drag any arrangement marker to copy that entire section, contents and all, to a new point in the timeline.

⌘ + DRAG

045

Delete a section and close the gap in one move

Right-click an arrangement marker and choose Delete to remove the marker only, or Delete and Move to pull everything after it back and close the hole.

046

Insert silence across the whole project

Set the locators, then Edit > Cut/Insert Time > Insert Silence at Locators. Every track and every automation point shifts. This is how you add two bars to an intro without wrecking the mix.

047

Snap arrangement markers to your actual section boundaries

Select a region that spans exactly one section, hit U to set the locators to it, then create the arrangement marker. It lands perfectly instead of approximately.

U

BUILDING AND DUPLICATING

048

Repeat regions numerically instead of dragging

Select regions and hit ⌘R for a single repeat, or use Edit > Repeat Regions to type an exact number of copies and choose whether they land as copies or aliases.

⌘R

049

Loop a region instead of copying it

Grab the top-right corner of a region and drag right to loop it. Looped regions update everywhere when you edit the original, and they cost nothing to change.

L

050

Convert loops to real regions only at the very end

Region > Loops > Convert Loops to Real Copies. Stay looped as long as possible so a single edit propagates, then commit when the arrangement is locked.

051

Use aliases for parts that must stay identical

⌘⇧-drag a MIDI region to create an alias. Edit the parent and every alias follows. Perfect for doubled parts across a whole song.

⌘⇧ + DRAG

052

Make a folder out of a section

Select every region in a section and use Functions > Folder > Pack Folder. The arrangement collapses to one block you can move, copy and mute as a unit.

053

GOLDEN NUGGET

Colour-code sections, not instruments

Open the colour palette with ⌘⇧C and give every chorus the same colour across all tracks. You can then read the arrangement at a glance from fully zoomed out.

⌘⇧C

JUDGING THE ARRANGEMENT

054

Zoom all the way out and squint

Hit Z with nothing selected to fit the whole project on screen. If the energy shape of the song is not visible from the region blocks alone, the arrangement is probably flat.

Z

055

Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families

Select related tracks and hit ⌘↑D to create a Summing Stack. Drums become one lane, and the arrangement becomes readable.

⌘↑D

056

Solo an arrangement section with the locators

Click an arrangement marker to set the locators to that section instantly, then hit C. You are now looping exactly that section with zero dragging.

C

057

Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting

Click a region with the Mute tool, or select and press M. Arrangement experiments become reversible without touching undo.

M

058

GOLDEN NUGGET

Keep a “graveyard” track at the bottom

Make one muted, hidden track and drag every rejected idea onto it. Nothing is ever deleted, and the good version of that rejected idea is there when you need it three weeks later.

059

Use markers for notes to self, not just sections

Create a marker from the Global Tracks marker lane, then rename it “fix snare here” or “vocal comp needed”. Your to-do list lives on the timeline instead of on paper.

SECTION 03

NAVIGATING TRICKS.

8 TRICKS

The shortest section in the book, and possibly the highest value per word. Getting the playhead and the view where you want them, instantly, is the difference between working and fiddling.

GETTING AROUND

060

GOLDEN NUGGET

Z is the only zoom command you need

Select anything and press Z to zoom that selection to fill the window. Press Z again to return to where you were. With nothing selected it fits the whole project.

Z

061

Drag-zoom to any area with $\text{^}\text{⌘}$

Hold $\text{^}\text{⌘}$ and drag a box around any part of the arrangement to zoom straight to it. Hold $\text{^}\text{⌘}$ and click empty space to zoom back out.

$\text{^}\text{⌘}$ + DRAG

062

Navigate by marker with the number keys

Markers 1 through 9 are jumpable directly. Set your song sections as markers and the whole arrangement is one keypress away.

063

Assign a key to “Play Selection”

It plays the selected region from its start and stops at its end without touching the locators or the position you were working at. Search the command name in Key Commands and give it a key — it is not on one by default.

⌘ K TO ASSIGN

064

Jump to an exact bar with the Go to Position dialog

Press / and type a bar number. Faster and more accurate than dragging the playhead, especially in a long project.

/

065

Scroll horizontally without the scrollbar

Two-finger swipe left and right on a trackpad, or hold ⌘ while scrolling with a wheel mouse. Keep your hand off the scrollbar entirely.

066

Use the Cycle area as a bookmark

Set the locators around the part you are working on with U. Even when you play elsewhere, clicking the cycle bar in the ruler takes you straight back to it.

U

067

Toggle Catch to stop the screen running away

The Catch button makes the view follow the playhead. Click it off when you are doing detailed editing and the view will hold still while the song plays. Search “Catch Playhead Position” in Key Commands to put it on a key.

⌘K TO ASSIGN

SECTION 04

COMPOSING MIDI TRICKS.

23 TRICKS

Getting ideas out of your head and into the sequencer before they evaporate. These tricks are about speed of capture first and correctness second — you can always fix it later, but you cannot un-forget an idea.

CAPTURE WITHOUT A KEYBOARD

068

GOLDEN NUGGET

Musical Typing turns your laptop into a synth

⌘K opens a playable keyboard mapped to your QWERTY keys. Z and X shift octaves, C and V shift velocity, and the tab key holds sustain. No controller required.

⌘K

069

GOLDEN NUGGET

Capture the last thing you played, even when not recording

If you played something great while the transport was rolling but not recording, hit ↑R — Flashback Capture — and Logic writes it to a region retroactively. This has saved more ideas than any other command in the program.

↑R

070

Record MIDI while the transport is stopped

Logic's MIDI buffer is always listening. Even with the transport parked, Flashback Capture will grab what you just played — notes and controller moves both.

↑R

071

Use the Step Input Keyboard for parts you cannot play

Open it from the Piano Roll and enter notes one at a time at an exact rhythmic value. Complex parts get entered accurately without a single quantise pass.

072

Draw notes with the Pencil tool and ⌘-click to remove

In the Piano Roll, the Pencil creates notes at the current division. ⌘-drag any note you drew to duplicate it at the same pitch.

073

Set the input velocity manually for drawn notes

In the Piano Roll's local inspector, set the velocity that new notes are created at. Draw hi-hats at 70 and kicks at 120 without editing afterwards.

074

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use the Chord Trigger MIDI plugin to play chords with one finger

Insert Chord Trigger in the MIDI FX slot, hit Learn, play a chord, then assign it to a single key. Whole progressions become one-finger performances.

075

Force everything into key with the Scale Quantize MIDI plugin

Insert Scale Quantize, pick your root and scale, and every wrong note you play is bent to the nearest right one in real time. Improvise freely without theory getting in the way.

076

Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them

Insert Arpeggiator, dial in a pattern, then drag the region onto a new track while holding the MIDI FX bypass to print the actual notes. You get an editable part instead of a live effect.

077

Transpose without touching the notes

Select a region and use the Region inspector's Transpose field. It is non-destructive, so you can audition a key change for the whole song in seconds.

078

Transpose only the notes, permanently

Select notes in the Piano Roll and use $\uparrow\uparrow$ or $\uparrow\downarrow$ to move them by an octave, or $\uparrow$ and $\downarrow$ for semitones. This is destructive and intentional.

$\uparrow\uparrow$ / $\uparrow\downarrow$

079

Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to remap anything to anything

Turn modwheel into aftertouch, velocity into CV, or pitchbend into expression without leaving Logic.

080

Double a part an octave down without a second track

Insert the Transposer MIDI plugin on a duplicate of the region's track, or simply select the notes, $\curvearrowright$ -drag them down an octave and lower their velocity by 20.

WORKING FAST WHILE IDEAS ARE HOT

081

Record into a cycle with take folders

Set the cycle, arm the track, and let it loop. With MIDI cycle recording set to create take folders, every pass is a separate take you can swap between later.

C

082

Merge takes when you are layering, not replacing

For building up a drum pattern one element per pass, set MIDI cycle recording to Merge instead. Each loop adds to the same region.

083

Use Replace mode to punch over a bad bar

Enable Replace in the transport and record over a section — the old MIDI in that range is removed rather than layered on top.

084

Name the region before you move on

Double-click a region name and type what it is. Twenty untitled regions in a week's time is a genuinely expensive mistake.

085

Use ⌘D to duplicate an instrument track with all its settings

Instant second layer with the same patch, ready to be detuned, transposed or re-voiced.

⌘D

086

Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done

Click the Freeze button in the track header to render the software instrument to audio. Your CPU comes back and the part is locked in.

087

Drag a MIDI region onto an audio track to bounce it instantly

Logic renders it through the instrument and its plugins. It is the fastest way to commit an idea to audio.

088

Keep one “sketch” instrument track loaded at all times

A piano patch on a permanently armed track means any idea is three seconds from being captured. The moment capture takes effort, ideas stop arriving.

089

Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls

Enable Note Repeat in the Step Sequencer or from the drum pad controls and hold a note to generate a perfectly timed roll at the current division.

090

Humanise deliberately with the Randomise function

Select notes, then Functions > MIDI Transform > Humanize in the Piano Roll. Set small values for position and velocity — 5 to 10 ticks is plenty.

SECTION 05

PIANO ROLL TRICKS.

21 TRICKS

The Piano Roll is where MIDI becomes music. Most people use about ten percent of it. Here is the rest.

SELECTING NOTES INTELLIGENTLY

091

GOLDEN NUGGET

Select all notes of the same pitch in one click

Click a key on the keyboard graphic at the left of the Piano Roll and every note at that pitch in the region is selected. Perfect for grabbing all the hi-hats at once.

092

Select similar notes with Edit > Select > Same Note Pitch

Works across the whole region and respects your current selection as the reference.

093

Select all following notes

Edit > Select > All Following selects every note from the current selection to the end of the region. Ideal for transposing the back half of a part.

094

Rubber-band select without hitting notes

Drag in empty space to lasso notes. Hold ⌘ to add to the existing selection rather than replacing it.

095

Use Select > Inside Locators to grab a bar range

Set the locators, then select only the notes inside them. Precise, repeatable, no mouse accuracy required.

EDITING NOTES

096

Nudge notes by tick with $\curvearrowright$ and the arrow keys

Set your nudge value in Edit > Move, then $\curvearrowright$ ← and $\curvearrowright$ → move the selection by exactly that amount. Groove work without the mouse.

$\curvearrowright$ ← / $\curvearrowright$ →

097

GOLDEN NUGGET

Change note length numerically in the inspector

The event inspector at the top left shows position, pitch, velocity, length and channel for the selection. Type a value and every selected note updates at once.

098

Set every selected note to the same length

Select notes, then Functions > Note Events > Note Force Legato, or simply type a length in the inspector to overwrite them all.

099

Force legato to fix gappy pads

Functions > Note Events > Note Force Legato extends every note to meet the next. Pads and basslines stop sounding stuttery instantly.

100

Trim overlaps automatically

Functions > Note Events > Note Overlap Correction cleans up doubled notes that cause phasing and stuck voices on hardware.

101

$\curvearrowright$ -drag a note to duplicate it

Hold $\curvearrowright$ while dragging any note or selection to copy rather than move. Hold $\uparrow$ too and it stays on the same pitch.

$\curvearrowright$ + DRAG

102

Use $\wedge\curvearrowright$ -drag for fine positioning

Bypasses the snap grid so you can place a note anywhere, tick by tick.

$\wedge\curvearrowright$ + DRAG

VELOCITY AND EXPRESSION

103

GOLDEN NUGGET

Drag velocity directly on the note with

Hold  and drag up or down on a note to change its velocity without switching tools. The note colour updates live.

 + DRAG

104

Draw a velocity ramp across a selection

Select a run of notes, then in the velocity lane hold  and drag to create a linear ramp from first to last. Instant crescendo.

105

Scale velocities rather than replacing them

Typing a velocity value flattens everything to the same number. Instead, drag the velocity of one note in a selection and the others move relatively, preserving the performance.

106

Show the automation lane inside the Piano Roll

Press A with the Piano Roll focused to reveal MIDI CC lanes underneath the notes. Modwheel, expression and sustain edit right next to the notes they affect.

A

107

Colour notes by velocity to read dynamics instantly

In the Piano Roll's View menu, set note colour to Velocity. Flat parts become visibly, obviously flat.

QUANTISE AND TIMING

108

GOLDEN NUGGET

Quantise from the region inspector, not destructively

The Quantize field in the Region inspector is non-destructive and can be dialled back or removed at any point. Use it before you ever use the destructive version.

109

Use Q-Strength to keep the human feel

Under the region's more-options triangle, Q-Strength at 60 to 80 percent pulls notes toward the grid without gluing them to it.

110

Quantise only the notes that need it

Select the offending notes in the Piano Roll and quantise the selection rather than the whole region. The good parts of the take stay untouched.

111

Use Q-Range to leave close notes alone

Q-Range quantises only notes that are further from the grid than a set amount, so a naturally tight performance is left alone while the strays get pulled in.

SECTION 06

RECORDING AUDIO TRICKS.

16 TRICKS

Recording is the one part of the process you cannot fix later. These tricks are about getting a clean, usable, well-organised take the first time, and never losing a good performance to a technical mistake.

BEFORE YOU HIT RECORD

112

Check your input with the channel strip's meter, not your ears

Aim for peaks around -12 dBFS with your loudest phrase. Recording hot is a habit from tape and it buys you nothing in 24-bit.

113

GOLDEN NUGGET

Drop the buffer to 64 samples for tracking

Round-trip latency below about 10 ms is the point where a performer stops noticing it. Do this before the singer walks in, not while they wait.

114

Turn on Low Latency Mode instead of disabling plugins one by one

It bypasses only the plugins that actually cause delay, keeping your monitoring chain intact.

115

Set the count-in and pre-roll separately

Count-in gives the performer the tempo. Pre-roll gives them musical context by rolling the actual track before the punch. Use both for punch-ins.

116

GOLDEN NUGGET

Name the track before you record, always

Logic names audio files after the track. "Audio 3#12.wav" three months later is a file you will never open again.

117

Record-enable multiple tracks at once

⌘-click a record enable button to arm every track, or select several track headers and hit the record enable on one.

WHILE RECORDING

118

Cycle record into take folders

Turn on cycle and let the performer keep going. Every pass stacks into a take folder, ready to be comped. Never stop between takes.

119

Punch in on the fly with R

With Quick Punch-In enabled, hitting R during playback drops you into record with the audio before the punch preserved.

R

120

Use Autopunch for surgical fixes

Enable the Autopunch button in the transport and drag the punch range in the ruler. Logic records only inside that range no matter when you start playback.

121

⌘. discards the take you just recorded

Stop and delete in one keystroke, when you know instantly that it was not the one.

⌘.

122

Watch the take folder count, not the waveform

The take folder header shows how many passes you have. If the performer is on take 14 and getting worse, it is time to stop and move on.

MONITORING AND HEADPHONES

123

GOLDEN NUGGET

Build a dedicated headphone mix on a bus

Send every track to a second output bus and give the performer more of themselves and more reverb than you would ever put in the mix. Comfort produces better takes than accuracy does.

124

Add reverb to the monitoring only, not the recording

Put the reverb on the headphone bus, not the input channel. The singer hears the polish; the file stays dry.

125

Use Input Monitoring rather than record enable to rehearse

The I button lets you hear the input without arming anything, so you can set levels and rehearse with zero risk of recording over something.

126

Turn off software monitoring if you hear yourself twice

The doubling is your interface's direct monitoring fighting Logic's. Pick one.

127

Give the performer a click they can feel

Swap the metronome sound, add a bar accent, or better, program a simple drum loop. A musical reference beats a woodblock every time.

SECTION 07

EDITING TIPS — AUDIO + MIDI.

16 TRICKS

The tricks in this section work identically on audio regions and MIDI regions. Learn them once and you have doubled their value.

UNIVERSAL REGION COMMANDS

128

GOLDEN NUGGET

⌘T splits every selected region at the playhead

Select multiple regions across multiple tracks and one keystroke cuts them all at the same point. This is how you chop a whole arrangement in one move.

⌘T

129

⌘J joins regions back into one

Works on audio and MIDI. On audio it creates a new merged file; on MIDI it merges the events into a single region.

⌘J

130

⌘-drag copies, ⌘↑-drag makes an alias or clone

The single most useful modifier in the program, and it behaves consistently everywhere.

⌘ + DRAG

131

⌘R repeats the selection once, instantly

For a numeric count, use Edit > Repeat Regions and type the number.

⌘R

132

Trim to the playhead from either direction

Functions > Trim > Region Start to Playhead Position, and the matching End command, trim exactly to the playhead. Both are worth putting on keys in ⌘K — no mouse precision needed.

⌘K TO ASSIGN

133

Use the length fields in the Region inspector

Position, length and loop status are all typeable. When precision matters, stop dragging and start typing.

SNAP, GRID AND PRECISION

134

GOLDEN NUGGET

Set Snap to Smart and leave it there

Smart snap adapts to your zoom level, so you get bar accuracy zoomed out and tick accuracy zoomed in, automatically.

135

Hold **^** to temporarily override the grid

Any drag becomes free-positioned while **^** is held. Release and snap comes back.

^ + DRAG

136

Turn on “Snap Regions to Absolute Value”

In the Snap menu. Regions snap to the grid itself rather than preserving their offset from it. Turn it on for tidy work, off when you are moving a region that is deliberately off-grid.

137

Use Nudge for repeatable movement

Set the nudge value in Edit > Move, then **⌘←** and **⌘→** move anything by exactly that value, every time.

⌘← / ⌘→

TOOLS AND SELECTION

138

Esc opens the tool menu, Esc twice returns to the pointer

Fastest tool switching in the program. Numbers 1–9 pick tools directly from the menu.

ESC

139

⌘ is your secondary tool

Hold **⌘** to temporarily switch to your assigned secondary tool. It is Marquee by default, which is exactly right.

⌘

140

Assign the Fade tool to **⌘** when doing audio cleanup

Set the secondary tool via the right-hand tool menu, then every **⌘**-drag across a region edge creates a fade.

141

Use Select All Following on a Track

Edit > Select > All Following selects everything after the current selection on that track. Perfect for shifting the second half of a song.

142

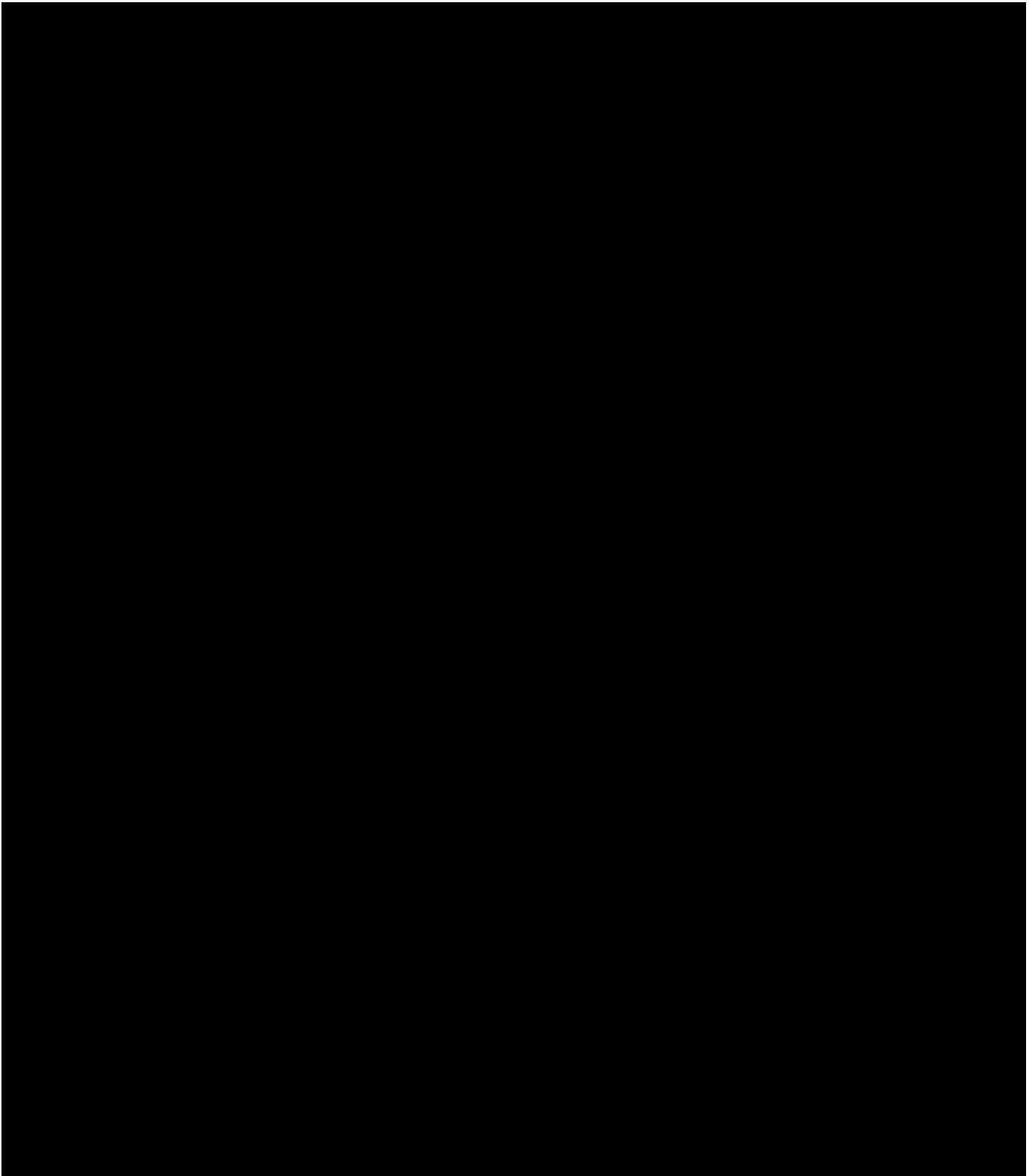
Select equal or similar regions in one command

Edit > Select > Same Colour, Same Name or Equal Regions finds all matching regions across the project instantly.

143

Lock a region so you cannot move it by accident

Select the region and use Region > Lock SMPTE Position, or lock the whole track with the padlock in the track header.



SECTION 08

AUDIO EDITING TRICKS.

22 TRICKS

Comping, crossfades, timing and pitch. This is where a good take becomes a great one, and where most of the invisible work in a professional record actually happens.

COMPING TAKES

144

GOLDEN NUGGET

Swipe across the take you want with the pointer

Inside a take folder, simply drag across the part of a take you want to hear. Logic builds the comp automatically and crossfades the joins for you.

145

Use **^** plus a number key to switch takes instantly

Each take in a take folder can be selected directly from the folder's header menu, and the take-switching commands live under "Take Folder" in Key Commands. Put the first three on keys and auditioning take 3 against take 7 becomes two keypresses.

⌘K TO ASSIGN

146

Save your comp as a new comp before changing it

The take folder menu has "Duplicate Comp". Do this before every significant change and you can always go back to the version that was working.

147

Flatten only when you are certain

Take Folder > Flatten turns the comp into regions. Flatten and Merge creates a single continuous file. Neither is reversible after the project is closed, so keep the folder as long as you can.

148

Zoom in on the joins and check them

Every comp point is a potential click. Zoom right in on each transition and confirm the crossfade sits in a gap, not on a consonant.

149

Move a comp edit point without redoing the comp

Drag the vertical divider between two take sections to slide the edit point earlier or later.

FADES AND CLICKS

150

Crossfade every edit point, without exception

Set the Fade tool as your secondary tool and drag across any region edge, or select the boundary and use Functions > Fades > Crossfade. Fades kill clicks, and every audio edit needs one.

151

Set default fade lengths in the Region inspector

Type a fade-in and fade-out value once, select all your regions, and apply it to everything at once.

152

Change fade curves by ^-dragging on the fade

An S-curve on a vocal edit sounds far more natural than a straight line.

^ + DRAG

153

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use "Remove Silence from Audio Region" for noisy tracks

In the Audio menu, this strips everything below a threshold you set and leaves separate regions. Great for cleaning up a live drum kit or a spoken word track.

154

Add a tiny fade to the start of every region as policy

Even 3 ms removes the click from a non-zero-crossing start. Do it to everything and you never chase a mystery click again.

TIMING AND PITCH

155

GOLDEN NUGGET

Flex Time is one keystroke away

Press ⌘F to show Flex, choose an algorithm in the track header, and drag transient markers to fix timing without cutting anything.

⌘F

156

Pick the right Flex algorithm or it will sound wrong

Slicing for drums, Rhythmic for guitars and loops, Monophonic for single voices and bass, Polyphonic for chords and full mixes, Speed for tape-style stretching.

157

Add flex markers either side before you move one

Placing anchor markers on the neighbouring transients stops your edit from stretching the whole bar.

158

Quantise audio with Flex enabled

With Flex on, the region's Quantize field in the inspector works on audio exactly like MIDI. Drums snap to the grid without a single cut.

159

Use Flex Pitch to fix a single flat note

Switch the track's Flex mode to Flex Pitch, then drag the note blob vertically. The gain, vibrato, pitch drift and formant handles are all on the same blob.

160

Reset a bad Flex edit rather than undoing repeatedly

The Flex track header has a Reset command that clears all flex data for the track and starts you fresh.

DESTRUCTIVE AND FILE-LEVEL EDITING

161

Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits

Double-click a region and switch to the File tab. Silence, reverse, normalise and pencil-edit at the sample level. Changes here affect the file itself.

162

Normalise regions non-destructively with Gain

The Region inspector's Gain parameter changes playback level without touching the file. Always try this before normalising.

163

Strip silence at the file level to reclaim disk space

After comping, Project > Clean Up removes unused portions of audio files. Back up first — this is genuinely destructive.

164

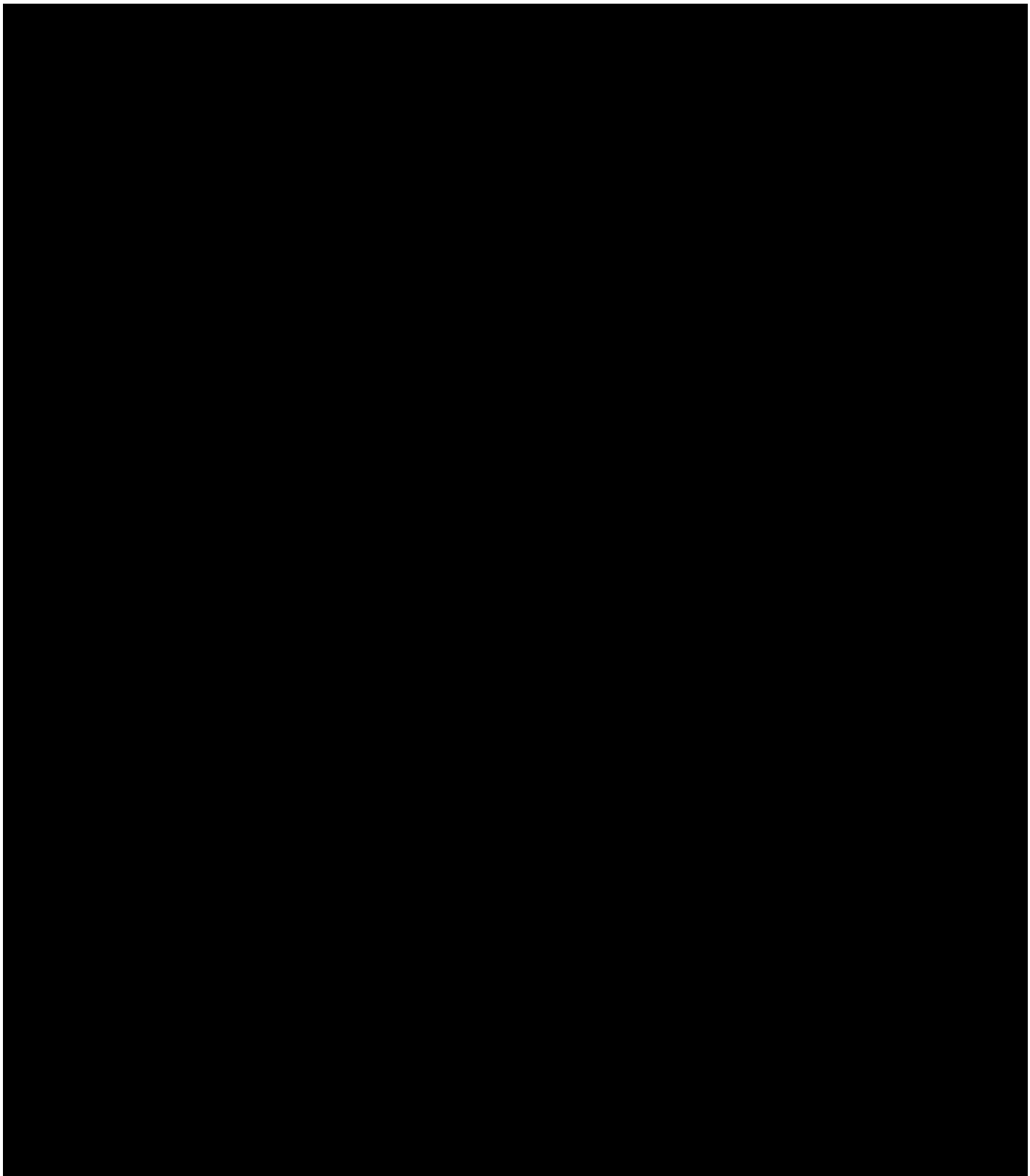
Reverse a region for a riser in two clicks

Select the region, then Functions > Reverse in the Audio File Editor, or apply the Reverse setting in the region inspector for a non-destructive version.

Convert a region to a new audio file to lock in edits

Audio File > Convert Regions to New Audio

Files prints your gain, fades and flex to a fresh file, which keeps big sessions responsive.



SECTION 09

MARQUEE TOOL TRICKS.

10 TRICKS

The Marquee tool is the most underused thing in Logic Pro. It selects time rather than regions, and once that clicks, half the editing you do by hand becomes unnecessary. It is the ⌘-click tool by default, so it is always one modifier away.

THE ESSENTIALS

166

GOLDEN NUGGET

⌘-drag anywhere to marquee select

Marquee is Logic's default secondary tool, so you never need to switch tools to use it. Drag a box across any range on any number of tracks.

⌘ + DRAG

167

Press Space and Logic plays only the marquee selection

Playback starts at the marquee's left edge and stops at its right edge. It is the fastest way to audition a specific range without touching the locators.

SPACE

168

Hit Delete to cut a hole in every track at once

Marquee across all tracks and delete. Every region in that time range is trimmed, on every track, in one action.

DELETE

169

GOLDEN NUGGET

Click any region after marqueeing to split at the marquee edges

Marquee a range, then single-click inside it, and Logic splits the regions at both marquee boundaries automatically. This is the fastest split in the program.

170

Set the locators to the marquee instantly

With a marquee selection active, hitting U sets the cycle locators to exactly that range. Marquee then U then C gives you a perfect loop in three keystrokes.

U

BEYOND SELECTION

171

Marquee automation to move only that range

With Automation view showing, a marquee selection over an automation lane creates edit points at both boundaries so you can raise or lower only that section.

172

Use marquee to create a drop

Marquee the bar before a chorus across every track and delete. Instant, clean, arrangement-wide silence with no dragging.

173

⌘-drag a marquee selection to copy that time range

Copies the audio and MIDI inside the marquee to a new position without disturbing the surrounding regions.

⌘ + DRAG

174

Marquee across a take folder to comp by range

Instead of swiping, marquee the exact bars you want and Logic uses the current take for that range.

175

Hold ↑ to extend an existing marquee

Fine-tune the selection edge by edge rather than redrawing the whole thing.

↑ + CLICK

SECTION 10

AUTOMATION TRICKS.

20 TRICKS

Automation is what separates a static mix from a moving one. Logic has two entirely separate automation systems and knowing which one you are in explains most of the confusion people have with it.

THE TWO SYSTEMS

176

GOLDEN NUGGET

Know the difference between Track and Region automation

Press A to show automation, then use the dropdown in the track header to switch between Track (fixed to the timeline) and Region (travels with the region when you move it). Choosing wrong is why your automation ends up in the wrong place.

A

177

Use Region automation for anything that belongs to the part

A filter sweep that is part of a synth riff should move with the riff. Region automation does that; track automation does not.

178

Convert between the two without redrawing

Right-click in an automation lane and choose Move Visible Automation to Region, or the reverse. Nothing is lost.

179

Press A to toggle automation view

One key. Learn it and stop hunting for the button.

A

180

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use Latch mode for almost everything

Latch writes while you move the control and holds the last value when you let go. Touch snaps back, Write erases as it goes, and Read plays only. Latch is the right default.

181

Never leave a track in Write mode

Write mode erases existing automation as the playhead passes, whether you touch the fader or not. It has destroyed more mixes than any other setting in Logic.

182

Draw automation with the Pencil tool for precision

Faster and more accurate than performing it for anything rhythmic — gates, stutters, hard mutes.

183

⌘-click an automation point to delete it

Faster than selecting and deleting, and it works on curves too.

⌘ + CLICK

184

Curve any line by dragging its middle with ^ ↑

Straight automation ramps sound mechanical. Curving them takes one drag and makes the move sound intentional.

^ ↑ + DRAG

185

Trim automation up or down as a group

In Trim mode, moving the fader shifts the entire existing automation curve up or down while preserving its shape. This is how you turn a whole automated vocal up by 1 dB.

186

Use Relative mode to layer a second pass

Relative automation sits on top of your existing pass as an offset, so you can add a ride without destroying the original moves.

187

GOLDEN NUGGET

Marquee a range then drag the line to change only that section

The marquee creates boundary points automatically so the change does not bleed into the surrounding bars.

⌘ + DRAG

188

Show every automated parameter at once

Use Mix > Show Automation, or the disclosure arrow at the bottom of an open automation lane, to reveal every parameter on the track that already contains data. Instantly see everything you have written.

189

Copy automation between tracks

Select the automation with a marquee, copy, select the destination track, and paste. It lands at the same timeline position.

190

Delete all automation on a track in one command

Mix > Delete Automation > Delete All Automation on Selected Track. Also available for the whole project when you want to start clean.

191

Automation follows regions if you tell it to

In Settings > General > Editing, turn on "Move track automation with regions". Now dragging a region takes its automation with it, which is what you almost always want.

192

Thin dense automation after recording a controller pass

Recording modwheel or a fader creates thousands of points. Select the range and use Mix > Delete Automation > Thin Automation to make it editable again.

193

Snap automation to the grid when it needs to be rhythmic

Automation obeys the same Snap setting as regions. Set it to 1/16 and your filter stabs land perfectly.

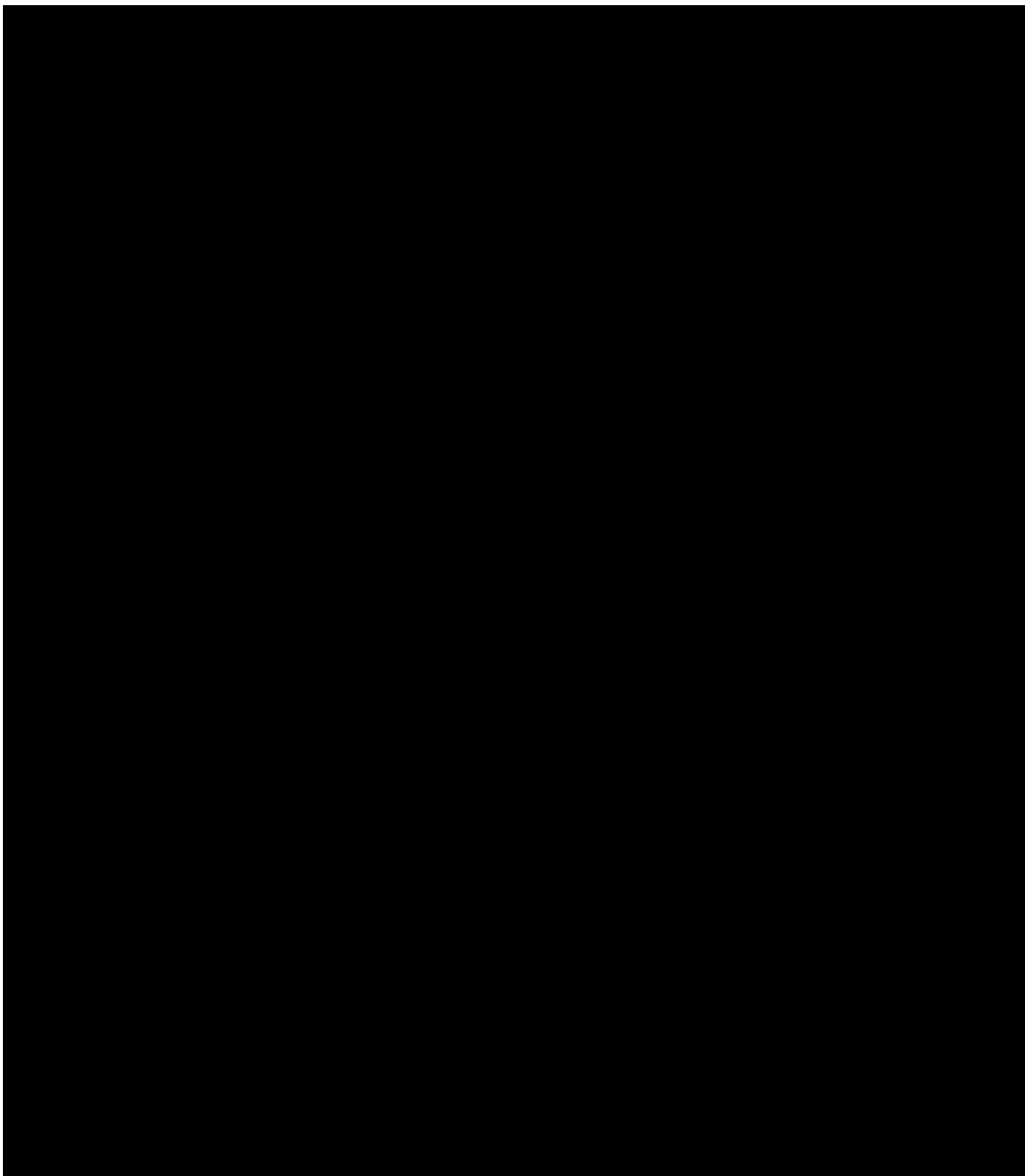
194

Automate plugin bypass for effect changes

Every plugin's bypass state is automatable. Automating a delay in and out is cleaner than automating its mix knob.

Automate send levels rather than plugin mix knobs

Sends give you a fader you can see on the mixer and a lane you can find later. Buried plugin mix knobs are neither.



SECTION 11

STEP SEQUENCER TRICKS.

16 TRICKS

The Step Sequencer is far more than a drum grid. Every row has its own length, its own subdivision and its own set of per-step parameters, which makes it a generative instrument if you let it be one.

THE BASICS DONE RIGHT

196

GOLDEN NUGGET

Create a Pattern Region to open the Step Sequencer

Right-click an empty area on a drum or instrument track and choose Create Pattern Region. The grid opens in the editor pane below — press E to show and hide it while you work.

E

197

GOLDEN NUGGET

Give every row a different step rate

Click a row's edit button and change its subdivision. Hi-hats at 1/16 against a kick at 1/8 against a perc at 1/12 creates polyrhythms with no effort at all.

198

Set different pattern lengths per row

A 16-step kick against a 15-step hi-hat takes 240 steps to repeat. This is how you get a loop that never sounds looped.

199

Use the row's Playback Mode for variation

Forward, Reverse, Ping-Pong and Random per row. Set the hats to Random and the pattern changes every bar on its own.

200

Increase pattern length beyond 16 steps

The Step Sequencer supports up to 64 steps per pattern. Longer patterns mean fewer copies and more room for fills.

PER-STEP EDITING

201

GOLDEN NUGGET

Switch the edit mode to change what you are drawing

The Edit Mode menu switches the grid between Velocity, Gate, Note Repeat, Chance, Tie, Loop Start, Skip and more. The same grid draws a dozen different parameters.

202

Use Chance to make a pattern breathe

Set a ghost snare to 40% chance and it appears roughly twice every five bars. Nothing else creates natural variation this cheaply.

203

Use Note Repeat for rolls without drawing them

Set a step's repeat value to 4 and it fires four times inside that step. Instant trap hats, no extra steps required.

204

Set Gate to shorten or lengthen individual hits

Short gates on a bass pattern create staccato stabs; long gates create glides. Per-step, not per-pattern.

205

Tie steps together for sustained notes

Tie mode joins consecutive steps into one long note, which is how you write bass and lead lines rather than just percussion.

206

⌘-click a step to reset it to default

Works on every parameter in every edit mode.

⌘ + CLICK

BEYOND DRUMS

207

Use the Step Sequencer on any software instrument

It is not a drum tool. Put it on a synth, switch the rows to pitches, and you have a hardware-style note sequencer.

208

GOLDEN NUGGET

Automate plugin parameters per step

Add a row and assign it to any automatable plugin parameter. Now you can sequence filter cutoff step by step alongside the notes.

209

Convert a pattern region to MIDI to edit it in the Piano Roll

Right-click the pattern region and choose Convert to MIDI Region when you need finer control than the grid allows.

210

Build a library of pattern regions

Save patterns to the Library or simply keep a muted track of favourites at the bottom of a template project.

211

Use Skip and Loop Start for live rearranging

Skip removes a step from the cycle entirely, changing the pattern's effective length. Loop Start moves where the row restarts. Both are performable.

SECTION 12

LOGIC DRUMMER TRICKS.

10 TRICKS

Drummer is not a loop library. It is a performance engine that responds to what the rest of your arrangement is doing, and once you know where the controls are it will out-play most programmed parts.

GETTING A REAL PERFORMANCE

212

GOLDEN NUGGET

Set the Follow parameter to your bass or guitar track

In the Drummer Editor, the Follow menu makes the kick pattern lock to the rhythm of another track. Your drums and bass become one part instead of two.

213

Use the X/Y pad, then fine-tune with the individual sliders

The pad sets loud/soft against simple/complex. The sliders to the right control each kit piece independently, which is where the real detail lives.

214

Change the drummer, not just the preset

Each drummer character has genuinely different playing tendencies. If a preset is close but the feel is wrong, swap the drummer and keep the settings.

215

Turn individual kit pieces on and off per region

Click a kit piece in the editor to enable or disable it for that region only. Drop the crash out of the verse and back in for the chorus.

216

Set fill amount per region for real dynamics

Zero fills in the verse, high fills in the last bar before the chorus. Fill amount is a per-region setting — use it as an arrangement tool.

217

GOLDEN NUGGET

Convert a Drummer region to MIDI and edit it by hand

Right-click the region and choose Convert > Convert to MIDI Region. You get the full performance in the Piano Roll to nudge, delete and re-velocity as you like.

218

Keep a Drummer region and a MIDI copy on two tracks

Convert a copy to MIDI for hand editing but keep the original Drummer region muted on a second track. You can always regenerate.

219

Use the Details panel for feel, ghost notes and hi-hat

Click the triangle in the Drummer Editor to reveal Feel (ahead or behind the beat), Ghost Notes and Hi-Hat openness. This is where a stiff pattern becomes a groove.

220

Give Drummer a groove template from your own track

Drag any region to the Groove Track slot and set the Drummer track to follow it, so the drums swing exactly like your guitar does.

221

Swap the kit without losing the performance

The Drummer track's plugin is Drum Kit Designer. Change the kit, tune individual drums, and adjust room and overhead levels without touching a single note.

SECTION 13

DRUM MACHINE DESIGNER TRICKS.

10 TRICKS

Drum Machine Designer is a Track Stack in disguise. Every pad is a real channel strip with its own inserts, sends and automation — which means you can mix a drum kit exactly like you mix a band.

BUILDING THE KIT

222

GOLDEN NUGGET

Drag any audio file straight onto a pad

Drop a sample onto a pad and Drum Machine Designer loads it into a Quick Sampler instance automatically. Building a custom kit takes about a minute.

223

GOLDEN NUGGET

Every pad is its own channel strip

Open the Mixer with X and you will see each pad as a separate channel inside the stack. Compress the snare, saturate the kick, send only the claps to reverb.

X

224

⌘-drag a pad to copy it, including all its processing

Perfect for layering — copy the snare, pitch the copy down, and blend.

⌘ + DRAG

225

Use the pad's Sound tab for quick shaping

Pitch, filter, start point, envelope and gain are all on the pad itself, so you can shape a sample without opening the sampler.

226

Assign pads to choke groups

Put the open and closed hi-hat in the same mute group and the closed hat cuts the open one, exactly like a real drum machine.

MIXING AND PERFORMING

227

Add a bus inside the stack for parallel compression

Create a send from every pad to one aux, put a heavy compressor on it, and blend it back. The whole kit gets glued without touching the individual hits.

228

Automate individual pads, not the whole kit

Because each pad is a channel, each pad has its own automation lanes. Filter just the hats in the breakdown.

229

Use the main stack fader for the whole kit

The Track Stack's top level is a summing bus. Put your kit compressor and limiter there and process everything together.

230

Convert a Drummer track to Drum Machine Designer

The electronic drummers use Drum Machine Designer natively, which means you can take a generated performance and then rebuild the kit sample by sample.

231

Save your kit as a patch

With the stack selected, save to the Library. Every pad, every sample and every insert comes back in one click on the next project.

SECTION 14

QUICK SAMPLER TRICKS.

16 TRICKS

Quick Sampler turns any sound into a playable instrument in about three seconds. It is the fastest route from “that noise is interesting” to “that noise is now a bassline”.

LOADING AND SLICING

232

GOLDEN NUGGET

Drag any audio onto an empty track area while holding nothing

Logic offers to create a Quick Sampler instrument from it. You can drag from the Finder, the browser, or straight from another region in your project.

233

Know the four modes and pick deliberately

Classic for straight playback, One Shot for drums and stabs, Slice to chop a loop across the keyboard, Recorder to sample live input. Choosing the mode is 90% of the work.

234

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break

Load a drum loop, switch to Slice, and every hit is mapped to its own key. Hit “Create MIDI” or drag the MIDI out and you have the original groove, fully rearrangeable.

235

Change slice division to Beat or Division instead of Transient

For loops with soft transients, slicing at a fixed 1/8 or 1/16 gives cleaner results than transient detection.

236

Sample directly from your input with Recorder mode

Quick Sampler will record from a mic or a bus. Sample your own reverb tail, your own voice, or another track in the project.

237

Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler

Replaces the sample while keeping every setting — your filter, envelope and effects stay exactly as dialled in.

SHAPING THE SOUND

238

Use Flex/Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

Turn on Flex in Quick Sampler and the sample follows tempo changes without changing pitch.

239

Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune

Quick Sampler guesses the pitch. If your bass is a semitone out across the keyboard, this is why. Set it manually in the Pitch section.

240

GOLDEN NUGGET

Turn on Loop with crossfade for infinite sustain

Set the loop start and end in the sustain portion of the sample and add a crossfade. A one-second sample becomes a pad you can hold forever.

241

Use the Sample Start modulation for variation

Modulate sample start with velocity or randomness and each hit sounds slightly different, which stops sampled drums sounding machine-gunned.

242

Reverse the sample for instant risers

One button in the waveform display. Reverse a crash, put it before the drop, done.

243

Use the Filter and its envelope, not an insert plugin

The internal filter is per-voice, so it responds to every note independently. An insert filter processes the summed output and sounds completely different.

GETTING IT INTO THE ARRANGEMENT

244

GOLDEN NUGGET

Drag MIDI out of Slice mode into the Tracks area

The generated MIDI plays the slices in the original order. Now shuffle the notes and the break rearranges itself.

245

Convert Quick Sampler to Sampler for full control

Right-click the plugin header and choose Convert to Sampler when you need multiple velocity layers, round robins or key zones.

246

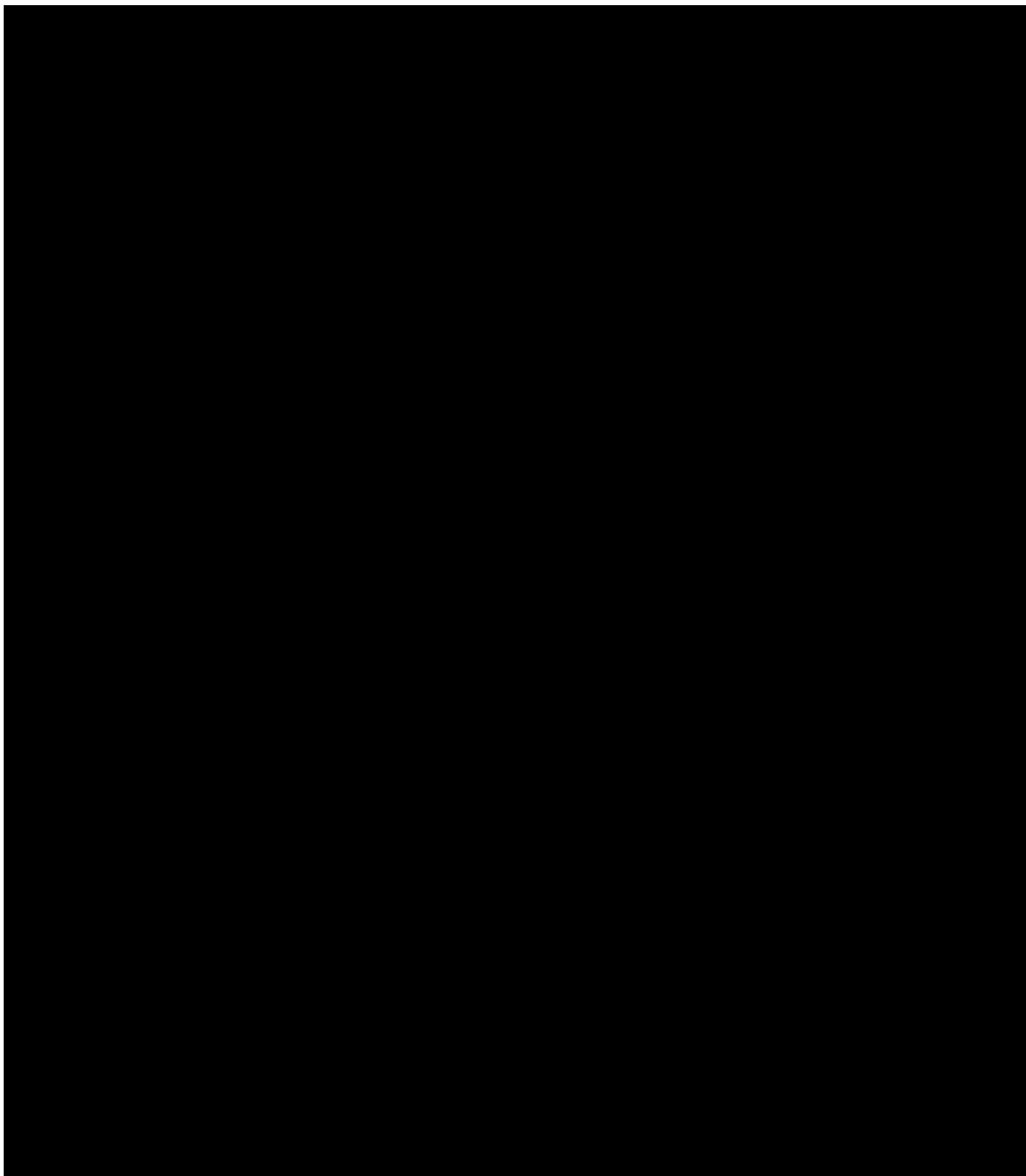
Save your instrument as a patch immediately

Chopped a break you like? Save it to the Library before you close the project, or it exists only in that one session.

247

Use one Quick Sampler per element rather than one big kit

Separate instances mean separate channel strips, separate processing and separate automation. Disk space is free; flexibility is not.



SECTION 15

MIXER TRICKS.

14 TRICKS

The Mixer is where a collection of good parts becomes a record. These are the organisational and workflow tricks — the ones that stop a 60-track session from becoming unmanageable.

GETTING AROUND THE MIXER

248

X toggles the Mixer, and it remembers your scroll position

Flip between arrangement and mixer constantly. It costs nothing.



249

Use the Single view to see one channel and its full signal path

The Mixer's view buttons switch between All, Single and Tracks. Single shows the selected channel plus every bus it feeds — the fastest way to debug routing.

250

Filter the mixer by channel type

The buttons along the top of the Mixer show or hide audio, instrument, aux, bus, VCA and master channels. Hide everything but auxes when you are setting up sends.

251

GOLDEN NUGGET

⌘-click any control to reset it to default

Faders to 0, pans to centre, sends to their default. Works on every control in the mixer.

⌘ + CLICK

252

⌘-click a Solo or Mute to apply it everywhere

Instantly mute or unmute the entire mixer.

⌘ + CLICK

ROUTING AND ORGANISATION

253

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use VCA faders for level groups without changing routing

A VCA controls the faders of its member channels without summing them through a bus, so your existing routing and sends are untouched.

254

Use Summing Stacks for processing groups

Select tracks and hit ⌘↑D. Everything routes to one aux you can compress and EQ as a unit.

⌘↑D

255

Create a send and Logic makes the aux for you

Click any Send slot and choose an unused bus. The aux channel appears automatically, already receiving.

256

Set sends to pre-fader for headphone mixes and effects that must stay constant

Right-click a send to switch between pre and post fader. Post is right for reverb; pre is right for a cue mix.

257

Copy a whole channel strip with ⌘-drag

Drag the channel strip settings area from one channel to another while holding ⌘ to copy every insert, send and setting.

⌘ + DRAG

258

Colour your channels to match your regions

Mixer channels take the track colour. A consistent colour scheme means you find the vocal bus without reading a single label.

PLUGINS IN THE MIXER

259

⌘-click an insert slot to see the plugin menu without loading

And ⌘-click an insert to bypass it without opening it.

260

GOLDEN NUGGET

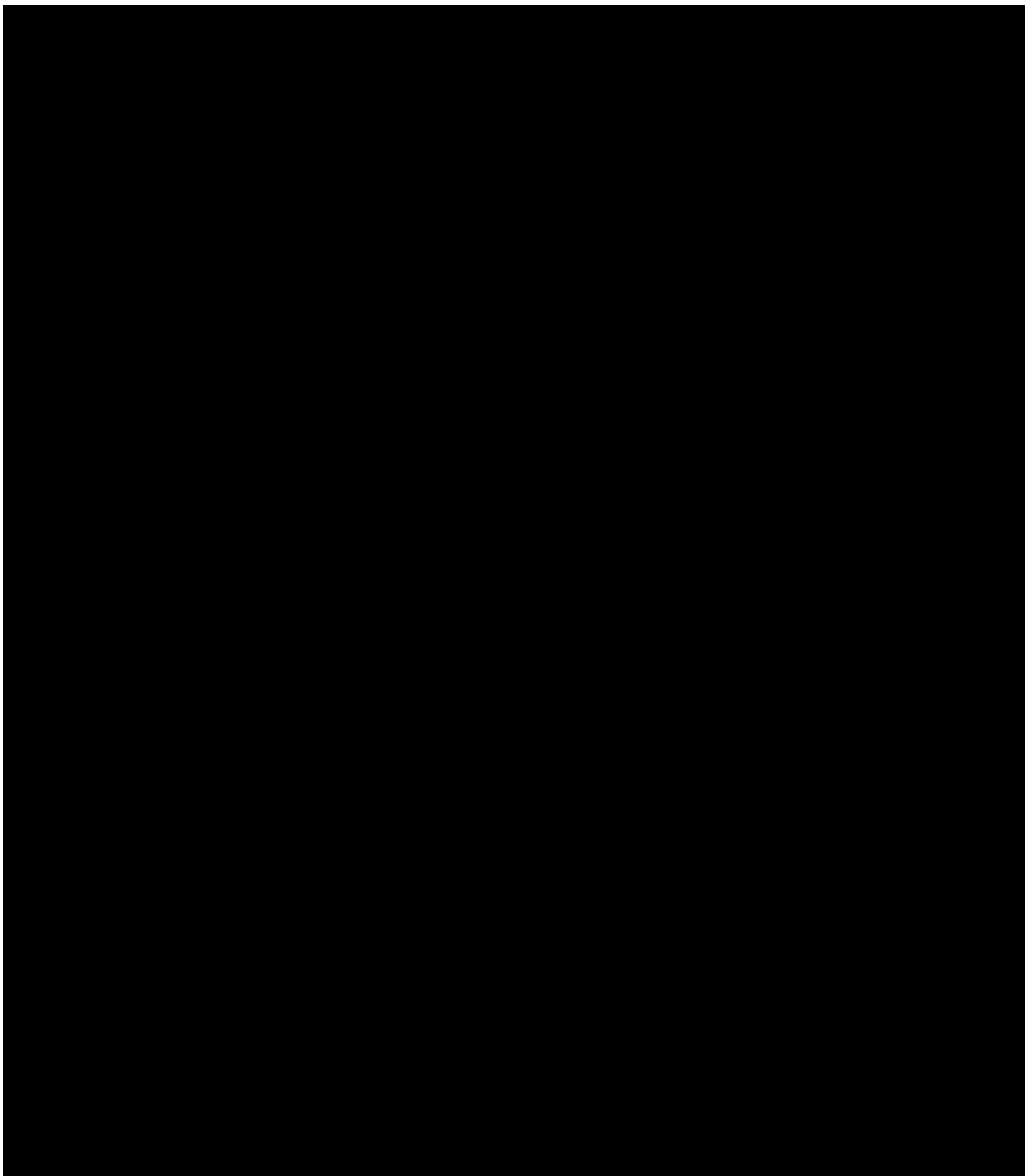
V hides every open plugin window at once

Press it again and they all come back exactly where they were. Essential on a laptop screen.

V

Drag plugins between insert slots and between channels

Reorder your chain by dragging, and hold ⌘ while dragging to another channel to copy rather than move.



SECTION 16

FAVORITE LOGIC PLUGINS.

20 TRICKS

Logic ships with a genuinely world-class plugin set and most people use six of them. These are the ones worth knowing properly, and the specific tricks that make each one worth reaching for.

DYNAMICS

262

GOLDEN NUGGET

Compressor — switch the model, not just the settings

The Compressor plugin contains seven distinct emulations. Platinum for transparent control, VCA for punch, FET for aggression, Opto for vocals, Classic VCA for glue. Same plugin, completely different characters.

263

Compressor — use the side-chain filter before reaching for a multiband

Filtering low end out of the detector stops a kick from ducking the whole mix. It solves most “my compressor is pumping” problems in one move.

264

Limiter — set it as a safety, not a loudness tool

One Limiter at the very end of the master with 0.5 dB of gain reduction stops overs. Anything more than 3 dB and you should be fixing the mix instead.

265

Multipressor — use it to control one problem band only

Bypass every band except the one you need. It becomes a dynamic EQ rather than a mix-flattening machine.

266

Noise Gate — use the side chain to key one sound from another

Gate a white noise layer from the snare's signal and you have an instant layered snare that follows the performance.

267

Envelope — reshape a transient without a compressor

Attack and release sliders that add or remove the front and tail of any sound. It makes a soft kick punchy in about four seconds.

EQ AND TONE

268

Channel EQ — turn on Analyzer and set it to Post

Seeing what you are cutting is worth more than any preset. Post-EQ analysis shows the result rather than the source.

269

Channel EQ — ⌘-drag a band for fine Q adjustment

Also, ⌘-click any band to reset it and double-click a gain value to type it exactly.

⌘ + DRAG

270

Linear Phase EQ on the master, Channel EQ everywhere else

Linear phase avoids phase smearing on the bus but costs latency and CPU. On individual tracks, the phase shift of the standard EQ is usually a feature.

271

Vintage EQ Collection — three genuinely different colours

The Console, Graphic and Tube EQs are modelled on classic hardware and they add character even with the controls flat. Try them before the Channel EQ on anything that needs attitude.

272

GOLDEN NUGGET

Match EQ — steal a tone rather than guess at it

Learn the spectrum of a reference, learn your track, and Match EQ builds the curve between them. Then pull the amount slider back to 40% — never use it at 100%.

TIME AND SPACE

273

GOLDEN NUGGET

ChromaVerb — use the Damping display as the main control

The frequency-dependent decay curve is what makes it sound expensive. Roll off the high end decay and the reverb sits behind the source instead of on top of it.

274

Space Designer — load your own impulse responses

Any short audio file can be used as an IR. Drop in a snare hit, a room recording, or a synth stab and you get convolution effects nothing else can produce.

275

Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes

Each tap has independent time, pan, pitch, filter and level. It is a sequencer for delay taps and it will do things no other delay can.

276

Stereo Delay — set different times per side

1/8 on the left and dotted 1/8 on the right creates width and movement from a single mono source.

277

Tape Delay — turn up Flutter for analogue character

The modulation and filtering are what separate it from a plain digital delay. Feed it a little and it glues into the track.

CHARACTER AND UTILITY

278

Phat FX — one plugin, an entire character chain

Distortion, filter, modulation, compression and a magnetic saturator in a single window. It is the fastest way to make a sterile synth interesting.

279

Remix FX — perform DJ effects live and record them

Filter, gater, downsampler, tape stop and reverse, all designed to be automated. Put it on a bus and record a performance pass.

280

GOLDEN NUGGET

Gain — use it to check phase, not just level

The Gain plugin's Phase Invert button is the fastest phase check in Logic. Flip it, listen for the low end, keep whichever is bigger.

281

Test Oscillator — reference tones for calibration

Generates sine, square and noise at exact frequencies. Essential when you are matching levels or setting up a room.

SECTION 17

MORE TRICKS.

18 TRICKS

The ones that did not fit anywhere else, which is often a sign that they are the most useful. Templates, key commands, project hygiene, bouncing and the small habits that quietly save hours.

KEY COMMANDS AND CUSTOMISATION

282

GOLDEN NUGGET

Open Key Commands with $\text{⌘}K$ and use the search box

Every command in Logic is searchable by name. If you can describe what you want to do, you can find and assign a key for it in about ten seconds.

$\text{⌘}K$

283

Export your key commands and back them up

The Key Commands window has an Options menu with Export. Losing a year of custom shortcuts to a reinstall is entirely avoidable.

284

Assign key commands to your most used plugins

Key Commands can insert a specific plugin on the selected channel. One key for your favourite EQ changes your mixing speed noticeably.

285

Use Touch Bar or a stream deck for tool switching

Any command with a key assignment can be triggered by external hardware. Tools, zoom levels and transport are the highest-value candidates.

TEMPLATES AND PROJECT MANAGEMENT

286

GOLDEN NUGGET

Build separate templates for writing, mixing and mastering

A writing template loads instantly with a handful of instruments. A mixing template has your buses and reference chain. They are different jobs and they deserve different starting points.

287

Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As

File > Alternatives keeps every version inside one project file with shared audio, so you are not duplicating 4 GB of recordings to try a different arrangement.

288

Turn on “Copy external audio files to project folder”

In Project Settings > Assets. It is the difference between a project that opens on another machine and one that does not.

289

Use Project > Consolidate before archiving

Gathers every asset the project depends on into the project package. Do this before backing up, always.

290

Keep a reference track in every project, muted at the top

A commercial track at the top of the session, routed to the master, muted. Unmute it whenever you lose perspective — which will be every hour.

291

Name your bounce files with the date

“Mix_v3.wav” tells you nothing in six weeks.
“Song_2026-04-18_mix3.wav” tells you everything.

BOUNCING AND EXPORT

292

⌘B bounces the project or the current section

Set the locators first and Logic bounces exactly that range. Bounce multiple formats in one pass by ticking more than one file type.

⌘B

293

GOLDEN NUGGET

Use “Bounce in Place” to commit a track to audio

⌘B for regions, or the Track menu for a whole track. You choose whether to include the effects, the volume and the pan.

⌘B

294

Export all tracks as audio files for stems

File > Export > All Tracks as Audio Files gives you one file per track, all starting at bar 1, ready to hand to anyone.

295

Turn off “Normalize” when bouncing stems

Normalising each stem independently destroys the relative balance you spent all day building. Set it to Off for stems and On only for a final master if you want it.

296

Bounce offline unless you have external hardware

Offline is faster and bit-identical. Realtime is only needed when audio has to physically leave and return through outboard gear.

297

Add 2 bars of silence at the end of the bounce range

Reverb and delay tails get cut off constantly. Extend the right locator past the last note and listen to the tail before you send it.

HABITS WORTH BUILDING

298

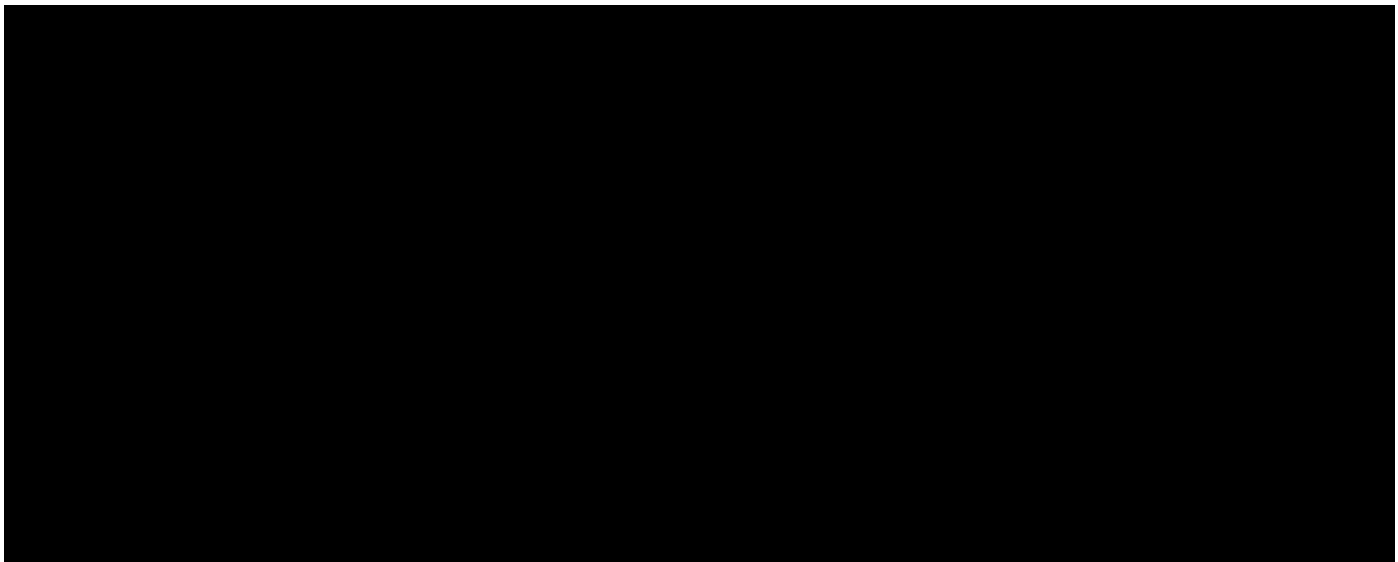
Colour and name everything before you leave the session

Five minutes at the end of a session saves twenty at the start of the next one.

299

Save a version before every major change

New Alternative, then experiment freely. Fear of breaking something is the biggest brake on creative decisions.



SECTION 18

LOGIC PRO 11 UPDATE.

42 TRICKS

Logic Pro 11 was the biggest release in years. Session Players, the Chord track, Stem Splitter, ChromaGlow and Flashback Capture between them change how a song gets written, not just how it gets edited. This section is everything worth knowing about the new tools.

SESSION PLAYERS — THE FUNDAMENTALS

300

GOLDEN NUGGET

Session Players are Drummer, extended to bass and keys

Create a Session Player track and choose Drummer, Bass Player or Keyboard Player. Each one generates a real, editable performance rather than playing back a loop.

301

Every Session Player region is convertible to MIDI

Right-click the region and choose Convert to MIDI Region. You keep the generated performance and gain full note-level control.

302

Use the Follow parameter to lock players to each other

Set the Bass Player to follow the Drummer's kick, and the Keyboard Player to follow the bass. The three of them lock like a band rather than three separate parts.

303

Session Players respond to region length, so write in sections

Give each song section its own region and set complexity and intensity per section. That is how you get a verse that builds into a chorus.

304

Swap the player character without losing your settings

The performance settings persist when you change the player, so you can audition every character against the same arrangement in seconds.

305

GOLDEN NUGGET

Set Feel to push or pull against the grid

Ahead of the beat for urgency, behind for laid-back. It is a per-region setting and it is the single most musical control in the panel.

306

Regenerate a performance without changing anything else

Small nudges to complexity or intensity produce a fresh take of the same part. If a phrase is not landing, nudge rather than rebuild.

307

Layer two Session Players on the same part

One playing simply, one playing busily, with the busy one low in the mix. Instant realistic double-tracking.

BASS PLAYER

308

Bass Player follows the Chord track by default

Build your progression once on the Chord track and the bassline follows it, including inversions and passing notes.

309

Use the Note Range control to keep the part in a register

Constraining the range stops the generated line from jumping octaves and keeps it sitting in the same place in the mix.

310

Adjust the Complexity slider before you adjust anything else

It controls how many notes the player uses per bar. Low complexity in a verse and high in a chorus is an arrangement decision made with one slider.

311

Turn on or off specific articulations

Slides, hammer-ons, dead notes and muted notes are individually switchable. Turning slides off alone makes a part sound completely different.

312

Pair Bass Player with Studio Bass for the intended sound

The playing engine and the instrument are separate. Studio Bass is the sampled instrument designed to respond to the articulations Bass Player generates.

313

Set the Bass Player to follow a specific track's rhythm

Point Follow at your guitar or piano and the bass locks to that rhythm instead of the drums, which is how you get a riff-driven arrangement.

KEYBOARD PLAYER

314

GOLDEN NUGGET

Choose the voicing style, not just the part

Keyboard Player offers different voicing approaches — close, open, rootless. Same chords, entirely different mood.

315

Use the left- and right-hand controls independently

You can simplify the left hand and keep the right hand busy, which is how real players comp behind a vocal.

316

Set the rhythmic density separately from the complexity

Sparse and complex is a very different thing from busy and simple. Both controls exist for that reason.

317

Convert to MIDI and delete the left hand entirely

The fastest route to a usable pad or Rhodes comp is to generate a full part and then remove what you do not need.

318

Use Keyboard Player as a writing tool, not a final part

Generate a progression, convert it to MIDI, then play the good bits yourself. The generated part becomes your reference.

319

Try it on a synth patch, not just a piano

The performance engine is instrument-agnostic. Point it at a pad or a pluck and the results are often better than on piano.

THE CHORD TRACK

320

GOLDEN NUGGET

Show the Chord track in Global Tracks

Press G, then enable Chord. Every Session Player and any track you tell to follow it will play the progression you enter.

G

321

Generate chords from an existing MIDI region

Drag a MIDI region onto the Chord track and Logic analyses it and builds the progression for you. Works on audio via the Chord analysis too.

322

Change one chord and hear the whole arrangement follow

This is the point of the feature. Swapping a minor for a major in bar 12 updates bass, keys and any following track instantly.

323

Use the Chord track to transpose the whole song correctly

Unlike a blanket transpose, chord-aware transposition keeps voicings musical rather than just shifting everything by semitones.

324

Set chord duration precisely by dragging chord boundaries

Chords snap to the grid, so a half-bar change is a two-second edit.

325

Turn Follow Chord Track off for parts that should not move

Each track has a Follow Chord Track setting in the region inspector. Turn it off for drums, samples and anything already committed.

STEM SPLITTER

326

GOLDEN NUGGET

Split any mixed audio into four parts

Select an audio region and choose Stem Splitter from the region's contextual menu. Logic separates vocals, drums, bass and other into four new tracks.

327

Use it on your own rough mixes, not just other people's records

The most legitimate and useful application is recovering a part from a bounce when the original session is gone.

328

Split first, then process — artefacts are frequency dependent

The separated stems have artefacts in predictable places. A gentle high shelf or a de-esser on the vocal stem cleans up most of it.

329

Use single stems as layers, not as full replacements

A split drum stem buried under real drums adds character without exposing the artefacts.

330

Split a loop to remove the element you do not want

Delete the vocal stem and you have an instrumental. Delete everything but drums and you have a break.

331

Splitting is non-destructive to the original

Your source region stays untouched on its own track, so you can always start again.

CHROMAGLOW

332

GOLDEN NUGGET

ChromaGlow is five saturation models in one plugin

Each model has a distinct character. Audition all five before you touch a single control — the model choice matters far more than the settings.

333

Use the Drive and Output together to stay level-matched

Saturation makes things louder, and louder always sounds better. Match levels before you decide whether it is actually helping.

334

Put it on the drum bus before the compressor

Saturating transients before compression gives the compressor less to fight and produces a much more controlled result.

335

Use the Detail control for high-frequency behaviour

It adjusts how the saturation treats top end, which is the difference between “warm” and “harsh”.

336

Try it on the master at very low drive

A tiny amount across the whole mix does what analogue summing is supposed to do. Anything you can obviously hear is too much.

337

GOLDEN NUGGET

Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played

The dedicated button in the control bar — or ↑ R — grabs the MIDI you performed even though you were not recording. A region appears at the playhead containing the performance.

↑ R

338

↑ R is already on the keyboard, so build the reflex

The whole value of the feature is that it costs nothing to reach for. Hit it the moment you play something you like, before you have decided whether it was any good.

↑ R

339

It works while the transport is stopped

Noodling with the song not playing is exactly when the good ideas arrive. Flashback Capture catches those too, and it captures controller moves as well as notes.

340

Use Mastering Assistant as an analysis tool, not a finisher

Run it, look at what it decided to do to your mix, then go and fix those things in the mix itself. Its EQ curve is a free critique of your master bus.

341

Check plugin compatibility after updating

Major releases drop support for older plugin formats. Open your three most important old projects and check every insert before you rely on the new version.

SECTION 19

LOGIC PRO 12 UPDATE.

20 TRICKS

A major Logic release is the one moment a working producer can genuinely lose a week. This section is the upgrade playbook — everything to do before, during and after — plus placeholder cards to fill in with the feature-specific tricks for the exact build you are running.

EDITORIAL NOTE — COMPLETE THIS SECTION AGAINST YOUR BUILD

The upgrade playbook below is evergreen and applies to every major Logic release. The feature-specific cards at the end of this section are intentionally left as templates: version-specific claims go stale the moment Apple ships a point update, so fill these in from the release notes for the exact version you are running rather than trusting a printed list. Every card marked ADD YOUR NOTES is a slot for you.

BEFORE YOU UPDATE

342

GOLDEN NUGGET

Never update in the middle of a paid project

The one rule that matters. Finish and deliver, then update. A new version halfway through a mix is a self-inflicted deadline problem.

343

Keep the previous version installed alongside the new one

Before updating, duplicate Logic Pro in your Applications folder and rename the copy with its version number. macOS will run both, and you have an instant fallback.

344

Back up your key commands, templates and channel strip settings

These live in your user Library, not in the app. Export key commands from the Key Commands window and copy your templates folder somewhere safe.

345

Consolidate and archive your three most important projects

Project > Consolidate on each, then copy them to a separate drive. If the new version changes something, you have untouched originals.

346

Check your critical third-party plugins against the new version first

Plugin developers lag major DAW releases. Check their compatibility pages before you update, not after.

347

Note your current I/O and buffer settings

Major updates sometimes reset audio device preferences. A screenshot of your Audio settings takes five seconds and saves a confusing afternoon.

348

Update macOS and Logic separately, a week apart

If something breaks, you want to know which of the two did it.

AFTER YOU UPDATE

349

GOLDEN NUGGET

Open an old project and audit every insert

Look for greyed-out or missing plugins on every channel. Do this before you assume everything migrated cleanly.

350

Rebuild your templates rather than opening old ones

New versions add track types, settings and defaults that an old template will not have. Rebuilding takes an hour and you get every new default for free.

351

Re-check Settings › Advanced and turn everything on again

Advanced Tools sometimes resets. If half the program has disappeared, this is the first place to look.

352

Read the new Key Commands list for additions

Open **⌘K** and sort by command name. New features arrive with new commands, many of them unassigned by default.

⌘K

353

Run the Sound Library update fully before working

Logic Pro > Sound Library > Download All Available Sounds. A half-downloaded library produces silent tracks that look fine.

354

Test your bounce path end to end before you need it

Bounce a short section to every format you deliver in. Export bugs are the ones that bite at the worst possible moment.

355

Give yourself a deliberate hour to explore

Not on a project. Open a scratch session and use every new feature once. An hour of play beats a month of accidental discovery.

FEATURE NOTES — FILL THESE IN FROM YOUR RELEASE NOTES

Each card below is a template. Open the release notes for your exact build, and replace the placeholder text with what you actually find.

356

ADD YOUR NOTES

New instruments and Session Players

ADD YOUR NOTES — list any new Session Player types, sampled instruments or synths, plus the one setting on each that makes it usable immediately.

357

ADD YOUR NOTES

New stock plugins

ADD YOUR NOTES — note each new plugin, which existing plugin it replaces in your chain, and the model or preset you actually reach for.

358

ADD YOUR NOTES

Editing and arrangement changes

ADD YOUR NOTES — record any changed default behaviour in the Tracks area, new snap or tool options, and anything that moved in the menus.

359

ADD YOUR NOTES

New AI and assistive features

ADD YOUR NOTES — for each one, write down what it does well, what it does badly, and the point in your process where it belongs.

360

ADD YOUR NOTES

Changed or removed behaviour

ADD YOUR NOTES — the most valuable page in any update section. Anything that used to work one way and now works another goes here.

361

ADD YOUR NOTES

New key commands worth assigning

ADD YOUR NOTES — go through `⌘K` after updating and list every new command you assigned, so you can rebuild it on another machine.

`⌘K`

THAT'S THE 361.

Now close the book and go and finish the song. The tricks are only worth something once they are muscle memory, and muscle memory only comes from sessions.

Come back whenever you get stuck. Every section is one click away from every page — that is the entire point of it.

LOGIC PRO CRASH COURSE